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Top Skills

SOX Compliance
B2B Partner Audit
Power BI

Nikita Rai

Senior SOX compliance & Risk Audit Specialist | Intel UK | Internal Audit | Internal control designs | Financial Management | Enterprise Risk Management | Controls Testing | MBA +ICAI
Swindon, England, United Kingdom

Summary

Most people see compliance as a checkbox, I see it as a design challenge.

My career started in chartered accountancy firms in India, working across tax consulting, statutory audits, and financial reporting.

I learned the technical foundations—understanding financial structures, navigating regulations, assessing risks. But what fascinated me wasn't just identifying problems. I wanted to solve them.

In 2017, I moved into startups as Finance Manager at Quintype Technologies (media-tech SaaS, HQ at New York) and Clover Ventures (agritech). This shift changed everything. I wasn't just reviewing controls, I was building them from scratch. Designing accounting systems, preparing for investor funding, managing cash flow across states, negotiating with vendors, detecting fraud, creating scalable processes with limited resources. Startups taught me to be resourceful, pragmatic, and focused on what actually moves the needle.

After earning my MBA from The University of Edinburgh in 2022, I joined Intel Corporation as Senior Risk & Controls Auditor for EMEA and Asia (occasionally) . Now I'm on the other side- identifying risks and testing controls across Fortune 100 multi-tier partner ecosystems, managing SOX compliance, conducting on-site assessments globally. I see where controls break down in complex operations and understand what works in theory versus practice. This dual perspective is valuable. I've been the tax consultant advising from outside, the finance manager building systems from inside, and the auditor validating from across the table. I've worked in resource-constrained startups where agility is critical, and in enterprise environments where managing complexity at scale is the challenge.

My strength is bridging the gap between compliance requirements and operational realities, designing systems that meet regulatory

standards while supporting business objectives. I work well in environments that evolve quickly and require both structure and flexibility. I've collaborated with stakeholders across functions and geographies, from negotiating with vendors to conducting assessments with global teams to presenting findings to senior management.

I hold an MBA from The University of Edinburgh and pursued Chartered Accountant from ICAI. I've worked across tax, audit, finance management, controls design, and risk assessment, in CA firms, startups, and Fortune 100 companies.

Core expertise: SOX Compliance · Internal Controls Design · Risk Management · Process Design · Stakeholder Management · Startup & Corporate Finance · Budgeting & Forecasting · Data Analytics

Experience

Intel Corporation

Senior Controls and Customer Audit Specialist (EMEA)

October 2022 - Present (3 years 5 months)

Swindon, England, United Kingdom

Leading SOX compliance and customer audit programs across Fortune 100 multi-tier B2B partner ecosystem (OEMs, distributors, integrators, resellers) in EMEA and Asia.

Key Achievements:

Own SOX compliance projects across high-value rebate programs from risk identification through control design, implementation, testing, and closure.

Collaborate with stakeholders across EMEA, Asia-Pacific, and US headquarters to drive SOX compliance within Fortune 100 matrixed organization.

Manage SOX compliance across multi-tier B2B partner network with complex rebate structures, contractual frameworks, and authorization hierarchies.

Drive significant monetary recoveries and compliance improvements through systematic control deficiency identification and corrective action programs.

Design SOX-compliant control frameworks, test scripts, process flows, and risk control matrices aligned with COSO principles including IT general controls.

Travel extensively across EMEA & Asia for on-site walkthroughs, facility inspections, and control assessments covering regulatory compliance, fraud prevention, sanctions, export controls, and GDPR.

Conduct global training sessions for audit teams and prepare executive reports for senior management and board committees.

University of Edinburgh Business School

MBA - Strategy and Marketing

September 2021 - October 2022 (1 year 2 months)

Edinburgh, Scotland, United Kingdom

Dissertation : Jumpstarting a Start-up: Strategic Decision-Making & Risk Management in New Ventures

Consultancy Projects:

Mac-Talla Whisky - Marketing Campaign

Yorkshire Building Society - Research report on future of bank branches

The GK experience - Youth Organization

Specialized in Strategy, Operational Improvement, and Finance. Completed consultancy projects for Mac-Talla Whisky (Marketing Campaign), Yorkshire Building Society (Future of Bank Branches Research), and The GK Experience (Youth Organization).

Enhanced leadership, strategic thinking, and problem-solving capabilities to complement 12+ years of finance, audit, and compliance experience.

Clover Ventures

Finance Manager

September 2020 - September 2021 (1 year 1 month)

Bengaluru, Karnataka, India

Built and led financial operations for high-growth agritech startup (#100M+ revenue) connecting farmers to consumers and B2B clients across multi-state operations.

Key Achievements:

Built finance function from scratch: Led 13-member finance team managing multi-channel revenue across two states.

Implemented SOX-compliant controls: Designed internal control framework (segregation of duties, authorization matrices, financial reporting), reducing control gaps by 60%.

Fraud detection: Identified and addressed \$0.6M fraud through robust control implementation

Optimized working capital: Reduced working capital cycle by 40% and vendor costs by 35% through strategic negotiations with 70+ suppliers.

Cash flow management: Managed forecasting and liquidity across 3 banks; optimized cash positioning for seasonal working capital.

Investor reporting: Delivered Series B financial reporting, burn rate analysis, 13-week cash flow projections, and investor MIS for board presentations.

Corporate compliance: Ensured statutory compliance and coordinated annual statutory audit completion.

Quintype Technologies

Finance Manager

March 2017 - August 2020 (3 years 6 months)

Bengaluru, Karnataka, India

Managed financial operations for New York-headquartered media-tech SaaS company providing digital publishing platform to 300+ publishers globally.

Key Achievements:

Established internal control framework: Built controls over financial reporting covering revenue recognition, expense authorization, and month-end close, reducing material weaknesses by 30%.

Drove cost optimization: Reduced costs by 25% and working capital cycle by 15% through strategic contract restructuring with clients and vendors.

Revenue recovery: Recovered through systematic client escalation resolution and payment cycle management

Audit management: Served as primary liaison for statutory and internal audits; coordinated queries ensuring timely completion and compliance

Cash flow management: Maintained banking relationships and optimized payment scheduling for operational liquidity

Team supervision: Managed and supervised accounting team, ensuring accurate books of accounts (Tally ERP)

Corporate compliance: Ensured quarterly and annual statutory compliance, tax payments, and regulatory filings

Ranga Rao & Associates, Chartered Accountants

Finance Executive and Tax Consultant

August 2015 - February 2017 (1 year 7 months)

Bengaluru, Karnataka, India

- Maintained day to day accounts of 4 companies- USA based Indian subsidiaries
- Prepared monthly Management Information System (MIS) reports of 4 companies
- Computed and finalized monthly tax for 8 companies (PF, PT, TDS)
- Expertise in direct taxation including individual, firms, scrutiny cases from the Income Tax Department
- Finalized and files annual corporate report including AOC 4 and MGT 7

Education

University of Edinburgh Business School

Master of Business Administration - MBA, Business strategy, Marketing · (September 2021 - August 2022)

The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India

ACA, Accounting and Finance · (August 2008 - March 2012)

Vidya Mandir PU College

Second PU, Business/Commerce, General · (2005 - 2007)

Kendriya Vidyalaya

High School · (2005)

The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India

Finance, General · (2007)